

OUT OF THE WHIRLWIND

TEXT: Job 1:1-3 “There was a man in the land of Uz, whose name was Job; and that man was blameless and upright, and one who feared God and shunned evil. 2 And seven sons and three daughters were born to him. 3 Also, his possessions were seven thousand sheep, three thousand camels, five hundred yoke of oxen, five hundred female donkeys, and a very large household, so that this man was the greatest of all the people of the East.”

Job 38:1-4 “Then the Lord answered Job out of the whirlwind, and said: 2 “Who is this who darkens counsel by words without knowledge? 3 Now prepare yourself like a man; I will question you, and you shall answer Me. 4 “Where were you when I laid

the foundations of the earth? Tell Me, if you have understanding.”

INTRO: Whirlwinds represent times of:

- Chaos...
- Struggle...
- Disorder...
- Resistance...
- Confusion...
- Bewilderment...

Everyone faces whirlwinds! Bad people along with good people face the whirlwind! Religious people as well as heathens face the whirlwind! Rich people and poor people face the whirlwind! Jesus said, ***“In this world you SHALL have tribulation, but be of good cheer, I have overcome the world.”***

In Houston, I shouldn't have to spend a lot of time describing whirlwinds! We are in the middle of hurricane season, and hurricanes have a way of disrupting literally everything and causing untold damage! I told a previous Music Director to stop singing the song "*Loves like a hurricane...*" This is the wrong city for that song!

Throughout life and ministry, we are all going to experience some whirlwinds, the question becomes, what will be our response to the whirlwind?

It's man's nature in his suffering to ask the question, "Why?"

It is our God-given nature:

- To reflect on right and wrong...
- To consider what is our purpose...

- To question and to contemplate...

Most often, when we face seasons of difficulty, we question "Why?" We do this because we are trying to get a handle on the meaning, purpose, or reason for it.

For example, if someone society considers evil dies, we may feel they had it coming and that justice is served.

Or if we do something evil and face hardship as a result, at least it makes sense to us.

But what are we to think, and how are we to feel when we suffer, or when we witness others who suffer "undeservedly?"

The Word of God has an answer for us!

Job 1:1-3 *“There was a man in the land of Uz, whose name was Job; and that man was blameless and upright, and one who feared God and shunned evil. 2 And seven sons and three daughters were born to him. 3 Also, his possessions were seven thousand sheep, three thousand camels, five hundred yoke of oxen, five hundred female donkeys, and a very large household, so that this man was the greatest of all the people of the East.”*

- Blameless - Complete, innocent, sincere
- Upright - Straight, level, just
- Feared - Reverent, honor
- Shunned evil - Turned away from evil.

In other words, *“Job was a man who lived a straight, innocent life, filled with honor and avoided evil.”* When the Holy Spirit declares

this about you, it is a good report! You can't do any better!

Please note, the fact that Job lived such a life did not prevent him from experiencing the whirlwind. In fact, the life that Job lived made him a target for the whirlwind. Job 1:6-12 ***“Now there was a day when the sons of God came to present themselves before the Lord, and Satan also came among them. 7 And the Lord said to Satan, “From where do you come?” So Satan answered the Lord and said, “From going to and fro on the earth, and from walking back and forth on it.” 8 Then the Lord said to Satan, “Have you considered My servant Job, that there is none like him on the earth, a blameless and upright man, one who fears God and shuns evil?” 9 So Satan answered the Lord and said, “Does Job fear God for nothing? 10 Have You not made a hedge***

around him, around his household, and around all that he has on every side? You have blessed the work of his hands, and his possessions have increased in the land. 11 But now, stretch out Your hand and touch all that he has, and he will surely curse You to Your face!” 12 And the Lord said to Satan, “Behold, all that he has is in your power; only do not lay a hand on his person.” So Satan went out from the presence of the Lord.”

The Word of God declares Satan to be "*The Accuser of the brethren.*" His name, the "devil," means in the Greek – "*One who casts himself between two persons to divide them.*"

Satan is criminally insane. He seeks to inflict suffering for suffering's sake. He is a murderer and a thief.

Notice the accusation of Satan: “*Job only serves You and worships You because you have blessed him.*” What a jerk!

This was not just an attack on the character of Job; it was an insult to the dignity and worth of Almighty God!

This challenge could not go unanswered. Job's devotion to God was to be proven in the fire of testing also known as the whirlwind.

Consider Job's trials relayed to us in the forthcoming chapters:

- He lost his livestock
- He lost his servants
- He lost his children
- He lost his health
- He lost his prestige

- His wife lost her wits - "*Curse God and die!*" (Who can blame her? Finances gone ... Kids gone... Health gone.)

Between chapter 1 and chapter 38 we find cycles of conversation between Job and his "comforters."

Their theology is simple:

- Good things happen to good people...
- Bad things happen to bad people...
- Bad things are happening to you...
- You must have done something bad...

But do you recall what we learned in the beginning? Job was considered, BY GOD, to be perfect, upright, righteous!

In the end of his season of trial - and **trials have a season** — God answers Job with a seventy-

four-question quiz! Job 38:1-4 **“Then the Lord answered Job out of the whirlwind, and said: 2 “Who is this who darkens counsel by words without knowledge? 3 Now prepare yourself like a man; I will question you, and you shall answer Me. 4 “Where were you when I laid the foundations of the earth? Tell Me, if you have understanding.**

Beginning with verse 4 and carrying on to chapter 42 are 74 questions God asks Job.

Questions aimed at reminding Job of God's:

- Wisdom...
- Creative power...
- Sovereignty... (He can do what He wants to, when He wants to, how He wants to, where He wants to!)

I like one commentator's notes on this passage:

“It must be noted that God never told Job about the reason for his pain, about the conflict between Himself and Satan, which was the reason for Job's suffering. He never gave Job any explanation at all about the circumstances of his trouble. He did one thing in all that He said. He asked Job if he was as eternal, great, powerful, wise and perfect as God. If not, Job would have been better off to be quiet and to trust Him.”

Though God did not reveal an explanation for Job's whirlwind, He did release a blessing! Rest assured, when God does not answer your questions it is because He is about to send a blessing that will render your questions insignificant!

God commended the faithfulness of Job and brought about healing and restoration to his life.

Job 42:10 “And the Lord restored Job’s losses when he prayed for his friends. Indeed the Lord gave Job twice as much as he had before. 11 Then all his brothers, all his sisters, and all those who had been his acquaintances before, came to him and ate food with him in his house; and they consoled him and comforted him for all the adversity that the Lord had brought upon him. Each one gave him a piece of silver and each a ring of gold. 12 Now the Lord blessed the latter days of Job more than his beginning; for he had fourteen thousand sheep, six thousand camels, one thousand yoke of oxen, and one thousand female donkeys. 13 He also had seven sons and three daughters. -- 16 After this Job lived one hundred and forty years, and saw his children and grandchildren for four generations. 17 So Job died, old and full of days.”

JOB'S WEALTH BEFORE THE TRIAL:

7,000 sheep @ \$245.00 each = \$1,715,000.00

3,000 camels @ \$3,500.00 each = \$10,500,000.00

1,000 oxen @ \$600.00 each = \$600,000.00

500 Donkeys @ \$600.00 each = \$300,000.00

TOTAL ESTIMATED VALUE: \$13,115,000.00

JOB'S WEALTH AFTER THE TRIAL:

14,000 sheep @ \$245.00 each = \$3,430,000.00

6,000 camels @ \$3,500.00 each = \$21,000,000.00

2,000 oxen @ \$600.00 each = \$1,200,000.00

1,000 Donkeys @ \$600.00 each = \$600,000.00

TOTAL ESTIMATED VALUE AFTER THE TRIAL:

\$26,230,000.00

Job 42:16 (NKJV) *"After this lived Job an hundred and forty years, and saw his sons, and his sons' sons, even four generations."* Job was 70 years old when his trial began, and he lived to be 210 years old! Job lived to see his great, great grandchildren! God gave him twice

as much life following his head-on collision with the devil, than he had before his problems!

CONCLUSION:

Can we stand in the midst of the whirlwind:

- To declare the goodness of God?
- To declare His worth?
- To declare His mighty power?
- To declare His righteous acts?

Are we ready to declare to the devil, that he will not persuade us that God has forgotten us ... that God does not care about us ... that God is not fair to us?

Are we ready to lift a sacrifice of praise from sincere hearts that will be a sweet-smelling fragrance before the throne of Almighty God?